Cheat sheet

Prompt Engineering

Patterns, templates and evaluation

Structure

Role	Expertise and perspective
Task	Clear action verb and goal
Context	Audience, background, data in tags
Format	Length, sections, JSON schema
Rules	Must / must not, tone, fallback behaviour

Techniques

Zero-shot	Instructions only
Few-shot	2–5 varied examples
Chain-of-thought	Reason step by step; final answer on its own line
Self-consistency	Sample several, majority vote
Tree-of-thoughts	Explore and evaluate several paths
ReAct	Interleave reasoning and tool actions
Prompt chaining	Pipeline of small prompts
Meta-prompting	Ask the model to improve your prompt
Prefill	Start the assistant's answer (e.g. `{`) to force format

Templates

prompt

```
<role>You are a {expert}.</role>
<task>{task}</task>
<context>{data}</context>
<format>Return JSON: {"answer": str, "confidence": "low|medium|high", "sources": [str]}
</format>
<rules>Use only the context. If unsure, answer "unknown".</rules>
```

Evaluation

Test set	Typical, edge, adversarial inputs
Checks	Schema validity, length, required keywords, banned content
LLM-as-judge	Rubric with 1–5 scores and reasons; calibrate against humans
Versioning	Prompts in Git; log version per response